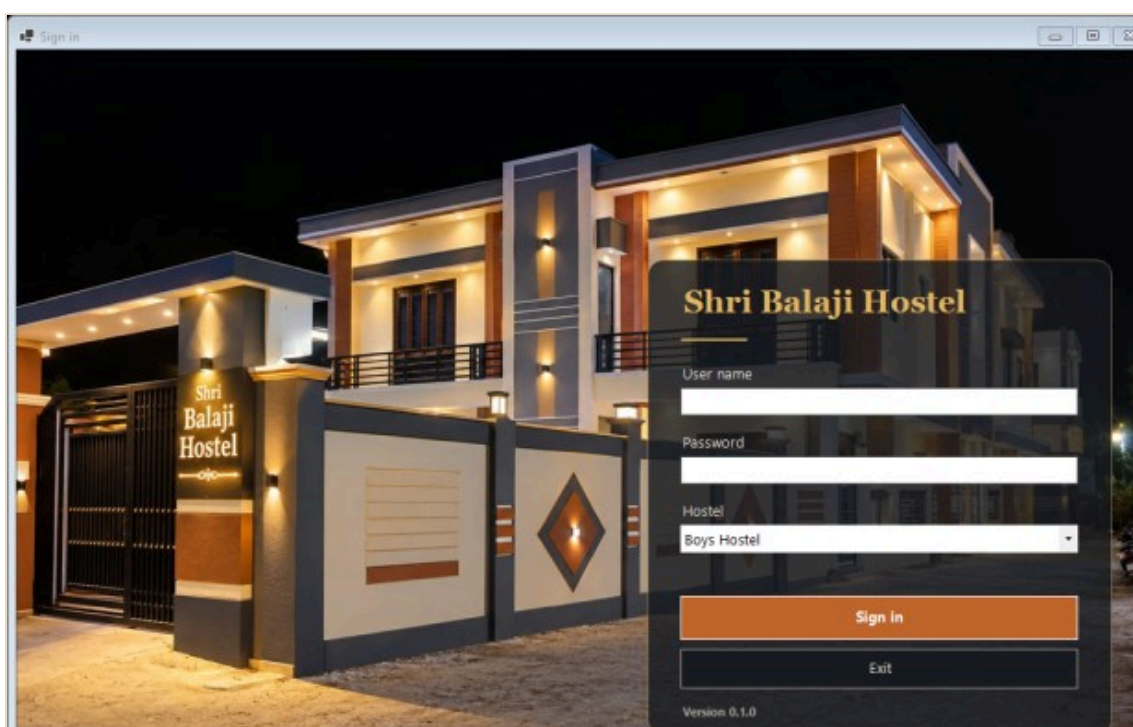


Shri Balaji Hostel

Hostel Management System: User Guide (version 1.0)



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1. Getting started

Start the program from the desktop shortcut **Hostel Management System**.

1. Enter the user name and password. A new installation uses **admin / admin**; change the password at once (section 11).
2. Choose the hostel to work on and click **Sign in**.

The menu on the left opens each screen. The hostel you work on is shown at the top right; change it there at any time. Colleges, rooms, students, invoices, payments, dues, reports and the dashboard always show the **selected hostel only**.

Fields marked with * are required. Messages in red under a form explain what to correct; nothing is saved until the form is correct.

2. Setting up a hostel

1. **Hostels**: click **Add**, enter the hostel name (address, phone and email are optional) and choose how often the hostel bills: **Twice a year** or **4 times a year**. Each new hostel gets the sharing types Single, Double and Triple, and the services Wi-Fi and Laundry (included in rent) and Transport (charged per month).
2. **Colleges**: add the colleges whose students stay in the hostel.
3. **Rooms**: first enter the **yearly rent** for each sharing type, then add the rooms: room number, floor, sharing type and whether the room is for boys or girls. The number of beds equals the sharing type.
4. **Services**: set the monthly rate for Transport. Services can be added, changed or switched off.

3. Students and parents

Add a student

1. **Students > Add.**
2. **Student** tab: name, mobile and admission date are required; choose the gender too, it decides the rooms the student can be given. The Aadhaar number is checked for typing mistakes.
3. **College & Stay** tab: college, course and class.
4. **Parent** tab: parent's name, mobile and email (invoices and reminders go to this email).
5. **Photo & Aadhaar** tab: add the photo (JPG or PNG) and the Aadhaar card (image or PDF), at most 5 MB each.
6. **Services** tab: tick Transport if the student uses it.

Use the search box and the filters (college, course, class, Active/Left) to find students. The Aadhaar number is shown masked (XXXX XXXX 1234) in lists and reports.

Parents / Guardians lists all parents; a student can have more than one, and the one marked **primary contact** receives the emails.

4. Rooms, check-in and the residency agreement

Check-in

1. **Room Allocation > Check-in.**
2. Choose the student, the room (only rooms for the student's gender with a free bed are listed) and the **bed**. The lowest free bed is chosen for you; change it if needed.
3. After check-in the program offers to create the **residency agreement** PDF straight away.

Transfer and check-out

Select the student in **Room Allocation** and click **Transfer** (to another room, same day) or **Check-out**. Check-out sets the student to **Left**; the history of every room is kept.

Residency agreement

Students > select the student > **Agreement PDF**. Choose where to save it; it opens for printing. The agreement fills in the student's name, S/o or D/o with the parent's name, address, Boys or Girls hostel, room and bed number, the number of beds in the room, the check-in date and the annual fee (yearly rent plus 12 months of transport, in figures and words). Students without an address get a dotted line to fill in by hand. To change the wording, click **Agreement Text...** on the Students screen. Words in curly brackets, such as {StudentName} or {BedNumber}, are filled in for each student. **Restore Default** brings back the original text.

4a. Night attendance

Attendance (under Students) lists the students who are in a room of the hostel that night, with room and bed. Everyone starts as **Present**.

1. At night, open **Attendance**; today's date is shown.

2. Untick **Present** for each student who is not in the hostel (add a remark if useful) and click **Save Attendance**.
3. The saved absent students appear on the right. Click **Email Parents** to email their parents (with a copy to the admin). Each parent is emailed once per date; the program asks before emailing again.

Choose another date to see or correct an earlier night. The text of the email is on **Settings > Email Settings > Absence email**.

5. Invoices

1. **Invoices > Create**.
2. Choose the student and the billing period (July to December and January to June, or four quarters from July), and the invoice date.
3. Check the lines shown and click **Create**.

The invoice holds the rent for the period (yearly rent divided by 2 or 4), Transport per month used, and Wi-Fi and Laundry at no charge. Invoice numbers look like **SBH/2026-27/0001**. **View / Print** opens the PDF, **Save PDF** saves it elsewhere, **Email** sends it to the parent. An invoice can be deleted only while it has no payments and no emails.

6. Payments and receipts

1. **Invoices > select the invoice > Record Payment** (or **Payments > Record**).
2. The pending amount is filled in; change it for a part payment. A payment can never be more than the pending amount.
3. Choose Cash, UPI, Bank transfer or Cheque. For everything except cash, enter the UPI transaction id, bank reference or cheque number.

Each payment gets a receipt number such as **SBH/R/2026-27/0001**. On the **Payments** screen, **View / Print** opens the receipt (with the amount in words and the balance still pending) and **Email Receipt** sends it to the parent. A payment entered by mistake can be deleted; its amount becomes pending again.

7. Pending dues and reminders

Pending Dues shows one line per student who still owes money, including students who have left, most overdue first. Payment is due **15 days after the invoice date**; after that the invoice is **overdue** and shown in red (no late fee is charged).

- Click a student to see the unpaid invoices below; **Record Payment** records a payment for the selected invoice.
- **Send Reminder** emails the parent of the selected student about the overdue invoices (with the invoice PDFs). **Remind All Overdue** does this for every overdue student. The **Last reminder** column shows when the last reminder was sent.
- **Export PDF** saves the list as shown.

8. Email (Gmail)

All emails are sent from the hostel's Gmail account **shribalajihostelsuddhowala@gmail.com**, and a copy goes to the admin's email (section 11). Gmail needs a 16 letter **app password**, not the normal password.

Create the app password (once)

1. In a browser, sign in to the hostel's Gmail account and open **myaccount.google.com > Security**.
2. Turn on **2-Step Verification** (Google sends a code to the mobile number).
3. Open **myaccount.google.com/apppasswords**, type a name such as *Hostel App* and click **Create**.
4. Copy the 16 letters shown in the yellow box (Google shows them only once).

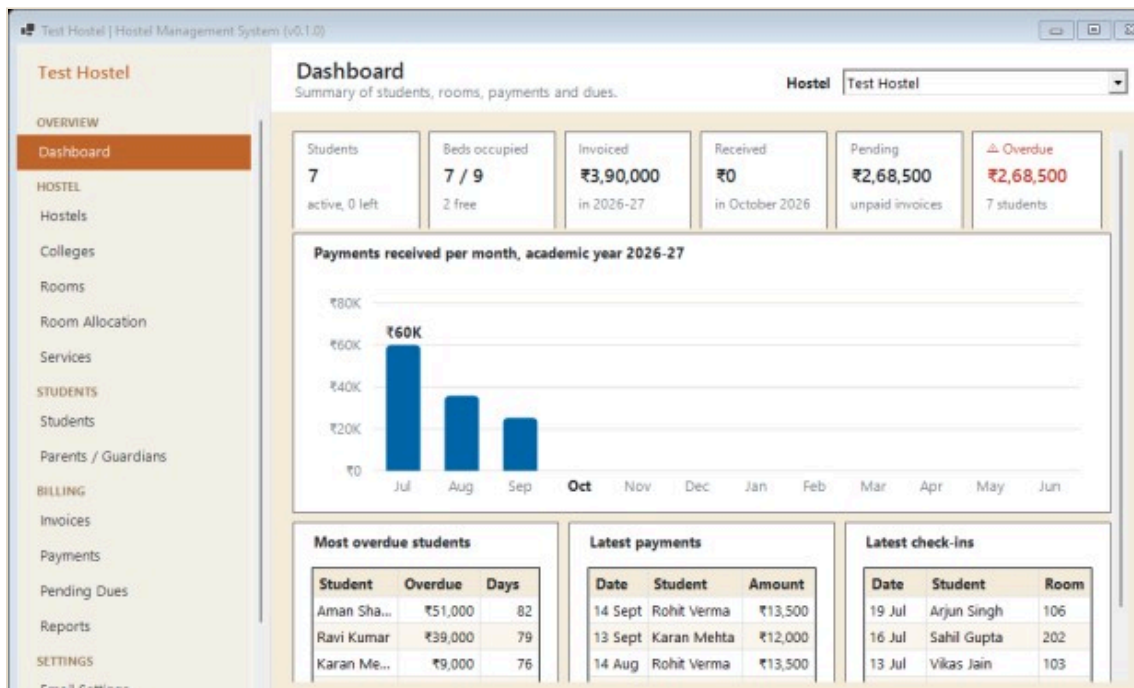
Enter it in the program

1. **Settings > Email Settings > Gmail account** tab: paste the app password and click **Save**.
2. Type an address in **Send test to** and click **Send Test Email**.

The tabs **Invoice email**, **Receipt email**, **Reminder email** and **Absence email** hold the texts of the emails; words in curly brackets are filled in. **Email history** lists every email, sent or failed, with the reason for a failure.

If the Gmail password is ever changed, Google cancels the app password: create a new one and enter it again. The app password is also needed again after moving to another PC.

9. Dashboard and reports

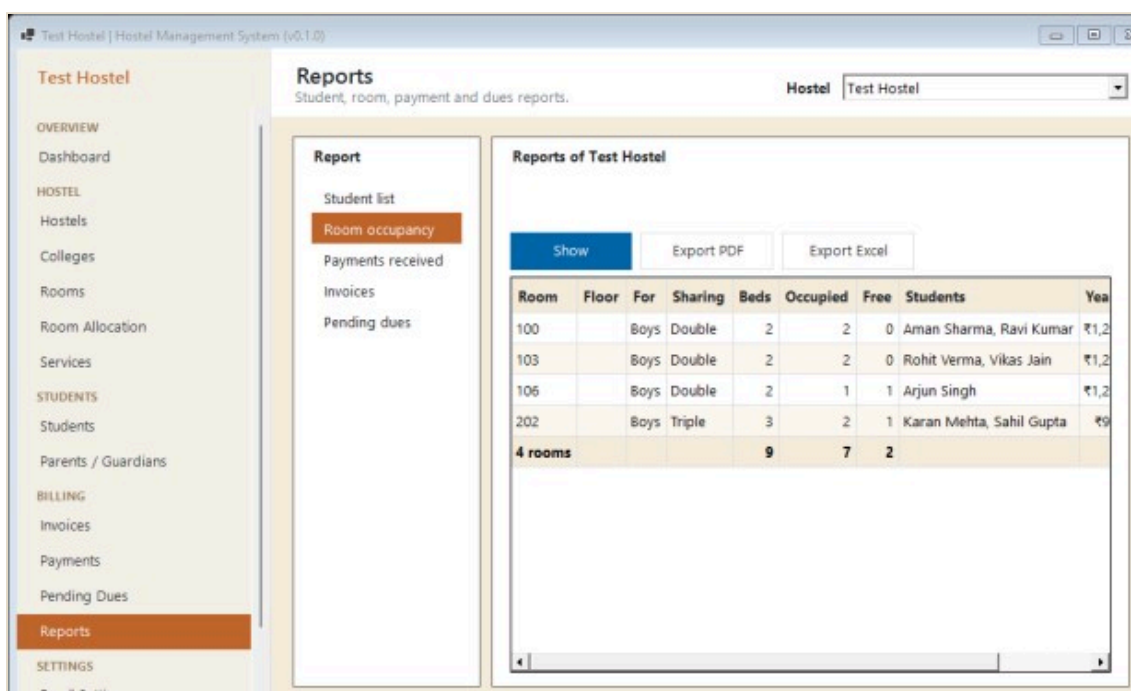


Dashboard with sample data

The **Dashboard** shows students, beds, the amount invoiced this academic year, received this month, pending and overdue, a chart of payments per month, and short lists of the most overdue students, the latest payments and check-ins.

Reports: choose a report on the left, set the filters, click **Show**, then **Export PDF** or **Export Excel**.

Report	Filters	Shows
Student list	Active/Left, college	Students with course, room, mobile, masked Aadhaar and parent
Room occupancy	none	Each room with beds, occupied, free, students and yearly rent
Payments received	dates, payment method	Payments with a total per day and per method
Invoices	dates, status	Invoices with total, paid and pending
Pending dues	overdue only	Students with their unpaid invoices



Reports: room occupancy

10. Backup and restore

A backup is one zip file with the database and all photos and Aadhaar cards, saved in **C:\HostelManagement\Backups**.

- An **automatic backup** is made once a day when the program is closed; the last 30 are kept.
- **Backup Now** makes a backup at any time; these are never deleted.
- **Second copy in:** choose a USB drive or a Google Drive / OneDrive folder; every backup is copied there too, so it survives if the PC fails.

Restore: select a backup and click **Restore Selected...** (or **Restore From File...**). All current data is replaced by the backup; the program first saves a backup of the current data (so a restore can be undone) and then restarts.

11. Admin account

Settings > Admin Account: enter the admin's email (it receives a copy of every email sent to parents) and phone, and change the password (at least 6 characters; enter the current password first).

12. Rules the program follows

Topic	Rule
Academic year	Starts in July. Billing twice a year (Jul to Dec, Jan to Jun) or four times (quarters from July), chosen per hostel.
Rent	Entered per year and sharing type; each invoice charges the yearly rent divided by 2 or 4. A student who joins during a period pays the full installment.
Transport	Charged per month used; part of a month counts as a full month.
Due date	15 days after the invoice date; then overdue. No late fee, no GST, no deposit, no discounts.
Payments	Always against an invoice, part payments allowed, never more than pending. Reference required except for cash.
Rooms	Boys or girls; beds = sharing type; one student per bed. Transfer and check-out on any day.
Emails	Sent only when you click a button; to the primary parent, with a copy to the admin.

13. When something goes wrong

Message	What to do
The Microsoft Access Database Engine was not found	Install "Microsoft Access Database Engine 2016 Redistributable" (64 bit), see Installation.txt in the program folder.
The database could not be opened	Close Microsoft Access or any other program that has the database open and try again.
Gmail did not accept the sender address and app password	Create a new app password (section 8) and enter it in Email Settings.
Could not connect to smtp.gmail.com	Check the internet connection and try again.
A file is in use / could not be saved	Close the PDF or Excel file that is open and try again.
Anything else	The message says what happened; technical details are written to C:\HostelManagement\Logs. Send that file with your question.